

Daily Bible Note

Date: September 2, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Psalm 119:17–32

17 Deal bountifully with Your servant, that I may live and keep Your word.

18 Open my eyes, that I may see wondrous things from Your law.

19 I am a stranger in the earth; do not hide Your commandments from me.

20 My soul breaks with longing for Your judgments at all times.

21 You rebuke the proud—the cursed, who stray from Your commandments.

22 Remove from me reproach and contempt, for I have kept Your testimonies.

23 Princes also sit and speak against me, but Your servant meditates on Your statutes.

24 Your testimonies also are my delight and my counselors.

25 My soul clings to the dust; revive me according to Your word.

26 I have declared my ways, and You answered me; teach me Your statutes.

27 Make me understand the way of Your precepts; so shall I meditate on Your wonderful works.

28 My soul melts from heaviness; strengthen me according to Your word.

29 Remove from me the way of lying, and grant me Your law graciously.

30 I have chosen the way of truth; Your judgments I have laid before me.

31 I cling to Your testimonies; O Lord, do not put me to shame!

32 I will run the course of Your commandments, for You shall enlarge my heart.

II. Key Summary

- The psalmist asks God for one thing after another: deal bountifully with him, open his

eyes, not hide His commandments, revive him, teach him His statutes, strengthen him.

- He says princes sit and speak against him and that he carries reproach and contempt; at the same time he says God's servant meditates on His statutes, and God's testimonies are his delight and his counselors.

- The section opens with "My soul clings to the dust" and "My soul melts from heaviness," and ends with "I will run the course of Your commandments, for You shall enlarge my heart."

III. Passage Analysis

Seeing starts with God opening your eyes

This reminds us that it isn't the word of God that needs changing, as if it were obscure; we are the ones who are veiled and can't understand the word of God apart from the work of the Spirit. [1]

When the psalmist could not see, his first move was to pray and ask God to open his eyes, and only then to look. What he asked for was not a simpler Bible but an opened self.

Choosing, clinging, running — the strength comes from God

"Choosing," "clinging," and "running" are the best description of godliness. If, after choosing, a person never lays God's word before him and never lets God enlarge his heart through that word, his legs will soon give out on the way of truth and he will not be able to keep clinging to it. [2]

The order in this section is clear: the psalmist is down in the dust, then he clings to God's testimonies, and finally he runs. He can run because God enlarged his heart first.

IV. Reflection Question

What is one thing you know you should do, and really do want to do, but have failed at so many times you no longer want to try?

The psalmist had also been down where his "soul clings to the dust," and there he chose to ask God to "enlarge my heart," and then he ran the course of God's commandments —

the strength you are missing is the strength he asked God for.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, Commentary on Psalm 119,
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/psalm-119/>

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study Site (ccbiblestudy.org), Comprehensive Bible Interpretation (聖經綜合解讀), Psalm 119,
<https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/19Psa/19GT119.htm>